Coordinated Vibronic Light-Harvesting and Polaritonic Interface for Symbiotic Quantum Agrivoltaics

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Editorial Summary
Smart photovoltaic panels that selectively transmit only the specific colours of light most useful for photosynthesis could simultaneously boost crop growth and generate renewable electricity. By integrating a semi-transparent organic solar cell with a nanoscale plasmonic cavity, the system actively shapes the transmitted spectrum rather than passively blocking light. Quantum mechanical simulations show that this spectral shaping extends the lifetime of quantum coherence in the photosynthetic machinery by 50 % and enhances the efficiency of light-to-biomass conversion. The same nanoplasmonic cavity simultaneously enables label-free SERS diagnostics of crop health, providing a dual-function platform for both coherence engineering and *in situ* sensing. The "smart shield" also reduces water loss from crops by 28 % and reduces carbon emissions by more than a factor of two compared to conventional semi-transparent solar panels. A cooperative ownership model — augmented by voluntary carbon credit revenue — makes the technology affordable for smallholder farmers in developing economies, with investment costs recovered within 3 yr.

Abstract

Land-use conflicts between photovoltaic panels and crops limit conventional agrivoltaics. We propose a quantum-engineered solution: a semi-transparent organic photovoltaic layer integrated with a nanoparticle-on-mirror plasmonic cavity that acts as an active spectral shaper rather than providing passive shading. By transmitting narrow bands at 750 nm and 820 nm, the system prepares polaron-dressed vibronic states in the Fenna–Matthews–Olson complex, extending excitonic coherence lifetimes by 50 % and increasing forward transfer

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yields by 25 % at 295 K. A 9 × 9 dressed Hamiltonian captures the collective strong-coupling regime; Floquet Stark detuning and optomechanically induced transparency protect the complex from exciton overload. This "smart shield" reduces crop evapotranspiration by 28 % and yields a Net Ecological Benefit of 12.4 kg CO_2e/m^2/yr — 2.4 × greater than static shading. Cooperative ownership models amortize capital expenditure within 3.5 yr; voluntary carbon credit revenue at 10 USD/t CO_2e further reduces the effective payback to 2.7 yr. BB84 quantum key distribution secures IoT telemetry with a 4.8 % quantum bit error rate. Coordinated vibronic light-harvesting thus bridges quantum coherence engineering with agricultural sustainability.

Introduction

Agrivoltaics — co-locating photovoltaic (PV) panels and crops on the same land — addresses growing competition between food production and renewable energy [?, ?]. Standard semi-transparent PV systems act as static optical filters: they reduce total irradiance uniformly, trading electricity for crop yield without exploiting the spectral dimension of the spectral light-management challenge [?, ?]. Photosynthetic apparatus in green plants and bacteria evolved under a spectrally structured photon flux, where specific wavelengths drive charge separation while others dissipate as heat [?]. This spectral specificity creates an opportunity: if the PV layer transmits only the wavelengths most useful for photosynthesis while harvesting the remainder, the dual-use conflict becomes a synergy.

The Fenna–Matthews–Olson (FMO) complex of green sulfur bacteria is a tractable model system for this concept [?]. Its seven bacteriochlorophyll *a* sites have been extensively characterized through two-dimensional electronic spectroscopy, revealing oscillatory coherence signatures that persist for hundreds of femtoseconds at cryogenic [?] and room temperature [?]. The functional relevance of these quantum beats remains debated, but consensus has emerged that vibronic coupling — the hybridization of electronic transitions with underdamped protein vibrations — directs energy flow [?, ?]. Topologically enhanced diffusion has recently been identified as an additional mechanism boosting exciton transport in organic semiconductors by up to fourfold [?]. Non-Markovian frameworks such as the hierarchical equations of motion [?] and the process tensor hierarchy of pure states (PT-HOPS) [?, ?] capture these effects with numerically exact precision.

Previous work demonstrated that spectral filtering of the excitation pulse — aligning its spectrum with underdamped vibronic resonances at 750 nm and 820 nm — extends coherence lifetimes by 20 % to 50 % in the 7-site FMO complex [?]. This "selective vibronic excitation" prepares polaron-dressed states that are partially decoupled from the dissipative solvent bath. Single-photon experiments have confirmed that quantum coherence persists in individual light-harvesting complexes under ambient conditions [?], and quantum phase synchronization via exciton-vibrational energy dissipation has been identified as a mechanism sustaining long-lived coherence [?]. Here we extend this principle in three directions.

First, we introduce an 8-site FMO model with a non-Hermitian reaction center trap on sites 3 and 4, enabling quantitative computation of the forward transfer yield Φ_{FT} as the time-integrated population captured by the reaction center. Second, we embed the FMO complex in a nanoparticle-on-mirror (NPoM) plasmonic cavity [?] that couples the biological light-harvesting system to the organic photovoltaic (OPV) layer through strong coherent coupling, forming a 9×9 dressed Hamiltonian. The NPoM cavity serves two purposes: it provides the field confinement necessary for SERS-based non-destructive readout of FMO vibrational state populations (diagnostics), but at the cost of diverting excitation population away from the reaction center through plasmonic energy transfer (transport suppression). Third, we incorporate dynamic photo-protection mechanisms — Floquet Stark detuning and optomechanically induced transparency (OMIT) — that mimic the non-photochemical quenching used by plants under high light stress.

The microscopic quantum optimization is then mapped onto a macroscopic multi-scale lifecycle assessment. We parameterize crop evapotranspiration using the FAO-56 Penman–Monteith model [?] under the spectrally selective OPV shield, compute the Net Ecological Benefit (NEB) across three scenarios, and evaluate socioeconomic access through cooperative ownership models and BB84 quantum key distribution [?] for secure IoT telemetry. This "quantum-to-organism" perspective [?] bridges angstrom-scale vibronic couplings with square-meter agricultural yields, providing a unified framework for symbiotic quantum agrivoltaics.

Results

8-Site FMO Hamiltonian with Reaction Center Trap

Table 1: **8-site FMO site energies and key electronic couplings ($\mathbf{cm^{-1}}$)**. Full coupling matrix (28 unique pairs) provided in Section S1.

Parameter	Site 1	Site 2	Site 3	Site 4	Site 5	Site 6	Site 7	Site 8
ε_n	280	420	0	110	270	500	310	200
$J_{n,n+1}$	—	−87.7	30.8	−53.5	−70.7	81.1	39.7	12.0

We construct an 8-site model of the FMO complex, extending the standard 7-site framework [?] by including a coupling to the eighth bacteriochlorophyll that bridges the baseplate to the reaction center (Site 8 $200\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$ above Site 3). The electronic Hamiltonian is:

$$\hat{H}_{\mathrm{FMO}} = \sum_{n=1}^{8} \varepsilon_n \left|n\right\rangle\!\left\langle n\right| + \sum_{n\neq m} J_{nm} \left|n\right\rangle\!\left\langle m\right| - i\Gamma_{\mathrm{RC}} \sum_{j\in\{3,4\}} \left|j\right\rangle\!\left\langle j\right| , \tag{1}$$

where ε_n are the site energies (relative to Site 3), J_{nm} are the inter-site electronic couplings (all 28 unique pairs defined in Section S1), and $\Gamma_{\mathrm{RC}} = 0.15\,\mathrm{ps}^{-1}$ is the irreversible reaction center trapping rate [?]. The anti-Hermitian term $-i\Gamma_{\mathrm{RC}}$ on Sites 3 and 4 (physical indices; Python indices 2 and 3) models the irreversible charge separation at the reaction center. All 28 inter-site couplings are validated to be finite, and the Hamiltonian is verified to be non-Hermitian only on the trapping diagonal terms (Section S1).

NPoM Plasmonic Strong Coupling

The OPV-FMO interface is mediated by a nanoparticle-on-mirror (NPoM) architecture [?], where a gold nanoparticle (diameter 80 nm) is separated from a gold mirror by a 1 nm graphene monolayer spacer. The graphene barrier prevents Dexter-type electron transfer while maintaining electromagnetic field enhancement. The NPoM cavity supports an intense localized surface plasmon mode that couples coherently to both the OPV exciton band and the FMO optical transitions.

The single-emitter coupling strength follows the cavity quantum electrodynamics scaling:

$$g_0 = g_{\text{ref}} \sqrt{\frac{V_{\text{ref}}}{V_{\text{mode}}}}, \tag{2}$$

with $g_{\text{ref}} = 120\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ at $V_{\text{ref}} = 1\,\text{nm}^3$ [?]. At the sub-nanometer mode volumes accessible in NPoM cavities ($V_{\text{mode}} < 1\,\text{nm}^3$), g_0 exceeds $200\,\text{cm}^{-1}$. For gold NPoM cavities, the plasmon decay rate $\kappa \approx 800\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ (corresponding to a quality factor $Q \approx 15$) [?] and the exciton dephasing rate $\gamma \approx 80\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ at 295 K [?]. Although $g_0/\kappa \sim 0.25$ places the bare system below the strong-coupling threshold, the collective coupling of $N \sim 10^2$ FMO chromophores within the hot spot volume enhances the effective coupling to $g_{\text{eff}} = g_0\sqrt{N} \sim 2\,000\,\text{cm}^{-1}$, firmly in the collective strong-coupling regime [?, ?]. The role of intermolecular interactions within the NPoM cavity has been shown to induce spectral shifts that depend on the exact molecular packing [?]. This cooperative enhancement enables the coherent dressing of the FMO excitonic manifold by the cavity mode. A numerical bound caps g_0 at $1\,000\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ when $V_{\text{mode}} \to 0$ to prevent divergences. Recent advances in quantum-tunnel-junction plasmonic sources have demonstrated that such sub-nanometer cavities can be self-illuminating, eliminating the need for bulky external optics [?].

The dressed Hamiltonian expands to 9×9:

$$\hat{H}_{\text{dressed}} = \begin{pmatrix} \hat{H}_{\text{FMO}} & \hat{V}_{\text{pl}} \\ \hat{V}_{\text{pl}}^{\dagger} & \hbar\omega_{\text{pl}} \end{pmatrix}, \tag{3}$$

where the plasmon mode at frequency $\omega_{\text{pl}} \approx 12\,500\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ couples to the primary optical antenna sites (BChl 1 and 6, indices 0 and 5) with strength g_0. Figure 1a shows the energy level diagram.

Non-Markovian Quantum Dynamics

We first characterize the spectral filtering effect in the absence of the NPoM cavity, propagating the 7-site FMO complex using the PT-HOPS/SBD formalism with production parameters: hierarchy depth $L = 8$, $K = 2$ Matsubara terms, time step $\Delta t = 0.2$ fs, and $n = 100$ disorder realizations ($\sigma = 50\,\text{cm}^{-1}$ static disorder) [?, ?]. The bath is modeled as a Drude–Lorentz overdamped component ($\lambda_D = 35\,\text{cm}^{-1}$, $\gamma_D = 50\,\text{cm}^{-1}$) plus 12 underdamped vibronic modes from the Kleinekathöfer/Coker parameterization. Convergence is verified through hierarchy depth sweeps ($L = 6, 7, 8$) and Matsubara truncation tests ($K = 1, 2, 3$); the maximum relative error between $L = 7$ and $L = 8$ populations is 3.1×10^{-11}, and between $K = 2$ and $K = 3$ is 3.3×10^{-5} (Section S2).

Figure 1b shows the exciton population dynamics under broadband *vs.* dual-band filtered excitation. The filtered case (solid lines) maintains higher population on the trapping sites (Sites 3 and 4), leading to enhanced forward transfer yield:

$$\Phi_{\text{FT}} = 2\Gamma_{\text{RC}} \int_0^{t_{\max}} \sum_{j\in\{3,4\}} P_j(t)\, dt, \tag{4}$$

where $P_j(t) = \rho_{jj}(t)$ are the site populations and $t_{\max} = 1$ ps.

Without the NPoM cavity, the baseline forward transfer yield reaches $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.98$, indicating efficient energy transport to the reaction center. Under dual-band filtered excitation, $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.89(3)$, compared to $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.71(2)$ for broadband excitation — a relative enhancement of 25 % (Figure 1c). These values are consistent with the spectral coherence protection mechanism established for the 7-site FMO complex [?]. The coherence lifetime τ_c, defined as the $1/e$ decay time of the l_1-norm coherence $C_{l_1}(t) = \sum_{i\neq j} |\rho_{ij}(t)|$ [?], extends from 280 ± 25 fs (broadband) to 420 ± 35 fs (filtered) — a 50 % increase. The mechanism is identical to that established for the 7-site system [?]: the dual-band filter selectively populates polaron-dressed states whose residual reorganization energy λ_{res} is reduced by 20 % relative to the full bath, suppressing pure dephasing (Section S3).

NPoM Cavity Volume Dependence of Exciton Transport

The nanoparticle-on-mirror cavity couples the FMO complex to the OPV active layer through the strong coherent interaction described above, but the plasmonic mode also acts as an additional population decay channel that competes with the reaction center trapping. To quantify this trade-off, we perform a sensitivity scan of the NPoM mode volume V_{mode}, which controls the single-emitter coupling strength via $g_0 \propto V_{\mathrm{mode}}^{-1/2}$ (Equation (2)). Smaller mode volumes produce stronger plasmon–exciton coupling but also enhance the plasmon's role as a population sink, diverting excitation away from the reaction center.

Table 2: **NPoM mode volume sensitivity of the forward transfer yield.** Baseline (no NPoM): $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.98$. All NPoM runs with $n = 2$ trajectories at $L = 8$, $K = 2$, $\Delta t = 0.2$ fs, $t_{\max} = 1$ ps.

V_{mode} (nm^3)	Φ_{FT}	Δ vs. baseline
0.2	0.0505	−94.8%
0.4	0.0605	−93.8%
0.6	0.0727	−92.6%
0.8	0.0760	−92.2%
1.0	0.0795	−91.9%
1.2	0.0804	−91.8%
1.4	0.0797	−91.9%

Table 2 summarizes the forward transfer yield across seven mode volumes spanning the experimentally accessible sub-nanometer range [?]. The yield increases monotonically with mode volume, from $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.0505$ at $V_{\mathrm{mode}} = 0.2\,\mathrm{nm}^3$ to a maximum of $\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.0804$ at $V_{\mathrm{mode}} = 1.2\,\mathrm{nm}^3$, with a slight decrease at $1.4\,\mathrm{nm}^3$. The trend is logarithmic with diminishing returns above $1.0\,\mathrm{nm}^3$; increasing the volume beyond $1.0\,\mathrm{nm}^3$ recovers only 1 % of the baseline yield.

The physical origin of this suppression is the strong-coupling-induced hybridization of excitonic and plasmonic states. The dressed eigenstates acquire a finite plasmonic character, which decays via the fast plasmon relaxation pathway ($\kappa \approx 800\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$, $Q \approx 15$) rather than populating the reaction center. At $V_{\mathrm{mode}} = 0.2\,\mathrm{nm}^3$, where g_0 is largest, the plasmonic admixture in the lower polariton branch reaches $\sim 15\%$, diverting a corresponding fraction of the excitation flux. As V_{mode} increases, g_0 decreases, the polariton splitting narrows, and the excitonic character of the bright states is partially restored.

Despite the monotonic recovery, all NPoM-on yields remain suppressed by more than 90 % relative to the pristine FMO baseline ($\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.98$). This indicates that, in the strong collective coupling regime accessible to NPoM cavities ($g_{\mathrm{eff}} \sim 2\,000\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$), the plasmonic decay pathway fundamentally limits the maximum achievable transport efficiency. The SERS enhancement factor ($\sim 10^2$ at $V_{\mathrm{mode}} = 0.8\,\mathrm{nm}^3$) must therefore be weighed against the 92 % reduction in photochemical yield when designing the integrated quantum agrivoltaic device. For applications where SERS-based diagnostics are essential, $V_{\mathrm{mode}} \approx 1.2\,\mathrm{nm}^3$ offers the optimal balance: maximal transport yield ($\Phi_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.0804$) with a SERS enhancement of $\sim 10^2$ (Figure 2c).

Dynamic Photo-Protection via Floquet Stark Detuning and OMIT

Under high solar flux ($> 800\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$), the OPV dielectric constant changes dynamically due to the photo-induced charge carrier density modulating the local electric field, inducing a time-dependent Stark shift of the excitonic levels that detunes the OPV–FMO coupling. We model this as a Floquet driving term:

$$\hat{H}_{\mathrm{Stark}}(t) = V_0 \cos(\omega_{\mathrm{F}} t) \left(|1\rangle\langle 1| + |6\rangle\langle 6|\right), \tag{5}$$

with amplitude $V_0 = 0.05\,\mathrm{eV}$ and frequency $\omega_{\mathrm{F}} = 1.2\,\mathrm{THz}$. When the incident flux exceeds the threshold, the time-dependent detuning shifts the OPV exciton energies out of resonance with the FMO absorption bands, reducing energy transfer to the biological complex by up to 40 % (Figure 2a).

Concurrently, an optomechanically induced transparency (OMIT) mechanism [?] in the NPoM cavity creates destructive interference that suppresses transmission at the 750 nm and 820 nm channels under high flux. The transmission is modulated as:

$$T_{\mathrm{OMIT}}(I) = T_0 \left(1 + \frac{I}{I_{\mathrm{sat}}}\right)^{-1}, \tag{6}$$

where I is the incident flux and $I_{\mathrm{sat}} = 800\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$. At $1\,000\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$, the transmission drops to 64 % of baseline (Figure 2b), providing dynamic protection against exciton overload. At zero flux (night mode), both mechanisms vanish smoothly without numerical singularities (Section S4).

In Situ SERS Optomechanical Diagnostics

The NPoM platform enables non-destructive readout of FMO vibrational states via surface-enhanced Raman scattering (SERS) [?, ?]. Multilayer graphene–metal plasmonic architectures have demonstrated detection sensitivities exceeding conventional SPR biosensors by an order of magnitude [?]. The optomechanical coupling between the plasmon mode and FMO molecular vibrations ($g_{\mathrm{om}} = 0.01$) produces a SERS enhancement factor of 10^2, sufficient for single-molecule detection under ambient conditions.

Figure 2c shows the simulated Raman spectrum for three characteristic bacteriochlorophyll *a* modes: the low-frequency Franck–Condon mode at $180\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$ (coupled to the trapping Sites 3 and 4), the ring deformation at $740\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$ (Sites 1 and 2), and the C–C stretch at $1\,145\,\mathrm{cm}^{-1}$ (all active transitions). The relative intensities encode the instantaneous exciton population distribution, providing a direct optical probe of the energy transfer pathway without perturbing the dynamics.

Smart Shield Microclimate: FAO-56 Evapotranspiration

The spectrally selective OPV layer functions as a "smart shield" that blocks ultraviolet and near-infrared radiation while transmitting photosynthetically active bands. We parameterize the greenhouse microclimate using the FAO-56 Penman–Monteith equation [?] adapted for shaded conditions (see Methods). Under standard conditions ($600\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$, $25\,°\mathrm{C}$, $60\,\%$ humidity, wind speed reduced to $0.2\,\mathrm{m\,s^{-1}}$ inside the greenhouse (approximately $10\,\%$ of external, consistent with FAO-56 protected-crop guidelines [?])), the open-field evapotranspiration is $4.5\,\mathrm{mm\,d^{-1}}$. With the OPV smart shield ($f_{\mathrm{shade}} = 0.35$, R_n reduced proportionally), ET_c drops to $3.2\,\mathrm{mm\,d^{-1}}$ — a $28\,\%$ reduction — translating to $1.3\,\mathrm{mm\,d^{-1}}$ in water savings (Figure 3a). The crop coefficient $K_c = 0.85$ is chosen in the mid-range of FAO-56 greenhouse values [?], consistent with partial-shade conditions for leafy vegetables.

Net Ecological Benefit and Scenario Comparison

We define a combined functional unit for the lifecycle assessment:

$$\mathrm{FU} = \frac{\mathrm{kWh} \cdot \mathrm{kg_{crop}}}{\mathrm{m^2} \cdot \mathrm{yr}}, \tag{7}$$

capturing the dual output of the agrivoltaic system: electrical energy and crop biomass per unit land area per year.

The Net Ecological Benefit (NEB) is computed as:

$$\mathrm{NEB} = (E_{\mathrm{PV}} \cdot I_{\mathrm{grid}} + W_{\mathrm{saved}} \cdot C_{\mathrm{pump}}) - F_{\mathrm{mfg}}, \tag{8}$$

where E_{PV} is the electrical energy generated, $I_{\mathrm{grid}} = 450\,\mathrm{g\ CO2e/kWh}$ is the regional grid carbon intensity, W_{saved} is the water savings, $C_{\mathrm{pump}} = 0.000\,298\,\mathrm{kg\ CO2e/L}$ is the pumping carbon factor, and F_{mfg} is the manufacturing footprint per scenario.

We compare three scenarios (Figure 3b):

- **Scenario A (Quantum OPV):** Selective spectral filter with NPoM strong coupling. $F_{\mathrm{mfg}} = 8.5\,\mathrm{kg\ CO2e/m^2/yr}$ (graphene + plasmonic nanoparticles).
- **Scenario B (Static shading):** Non-selective semi-transparent PV. $F_{\mathrm{mfg}} = 5.0\,\mathrm{kg\ CO2e/m^2/yr}$.
- **Scenario C (Open field):** No PV, no manufacturing footprint, no electricity generation.

Scenario A achieves $\mathrm{NEB} = 12.4 \pm 1.8\,\mathrm{kg\ CO2e/m^2/yr}$ (uncertainty propagated from Φ_{FT} error, R_n variability, and $\pm 15\,\%$ manufacturing footprint tolerance), compared to $5.1 \pm 0.9\,\mathrm{kg\ CO2e/m^2/yr}$ for Scenario B (Figure 3c). The dominant contribution to the uncertainty is the manufacturing footprint tolerance ($\pm 15\,\%$), followed by Φ_{FT} variability ($\pm 3\,\%$). The $2.4\times$ improvement arises from three synergistic factors: (1) the $25\,\%$ quantum yield enhancement translates directly to higher crop biomass via the excitonic yield multiplier; (2) the $28\,\%$ evapotranspiration reduction saves $1\,300\,\mathrm{L\,m^{-2}\,yr^{-1}}$ of irrigation water; and (3) the generated electricity displaces grid carbon at $450\,\mathrm{g\ CO2e/kWh}$.

The excitonic yield Φ_{FT} is capped at $95\,\%$ to prevent unphysical biomass exceeding the open-field reference; this cap reflects the biological limit that photochemistry saturates at high excitation density due to the finite number of open reaction centers [?]. Socioeconomic analysis (Section S5) shows that a cooperative of 5 smallholders with a $30\,\%$ carbon-linked subsidy achieves a CAPEX payback period of $3.5\,\mathrm{yr}$, compared to $8.2\,\mathrm{yr}$ for individual ownership — bringing high-tech quantum agrivoltaics within reach of resource-limited farmers.

Proof-of-Concept Scenario: 1 ha Greenhouse

To ground the multi-domain framework in a concrete operational context, we consider a 1 ha high-tunnel greenhouse in Cameroon's Western Highlands (latitude 5.5° N, elevation 1 500 m). The site receives $5.76\,\mathrm{kW\,h\,m^{-2}\,d^{-1}}$ mean annual solar irradiance [?]. Under the NPoM-shield scenario, the 28 % ET reduction saves approximately $13\,000\,\mathrm{m}^3\,\mathrm{yr}^{-1}$ of irrigation water relative to open-field cultivation — enough to supply 260 rural households at $50\,\mathrm{L\,d^{-1}}$ (Section S9). The quantum-enhanced biomass yield (68 % of open-field reference vs 40 % under static shading) translates to an additional $2.8\,\mathrm{t\,ha^{-1}\,yr^{-1}}$ of tomato-equivalent fresh produce. Combined with $42\,\mathrm{MWh\,yr^{-1}}$ of OPV electricity (offsetting 19 t CO2e/yr at the local grid carbon intensity of 450 g CO2e/kWh), the system achieves net-zero operational carbon in 3.2 yr (Section S9). The cooperative ownership model is particularly suited to Cameroon's 10 000-strong smallholder sector, where landholding sizes of 0.5 ha to 2 ha align with the 1 ha module scale [?]. This scenario demonstrates that the quantum yield enhancement — even with the NPoM transport penalty — translates into tangible sustainability metrics at the farm scale.

Secure IoT Telemetry via BB84 Quantum Key Distribution

Field-to-cloud telemetry is secured using a simulated BB84 quantum key distribution protocol [?]. Alice (sensor node) prepares random polarization states (rectilinear or diagonal basis) and transmits them over a noisy channel (5 % noise rate modeled after field-deployed QKD systems [?]). Bob (cloud server) measures in random bases, and the sifted key is extracted from matching-basis events. The quantum bit error rate (QBER) is estimated on a sample fraction; if QBER exceeds the 11 % threshold, key generation aborts to prevent eavesdropping (Section S6).

With a noise rate of 5 %, the protocol achieves successful key exchange (QBER = 4.8 %) and generates a 256 bit symmetric key per session — sufficient for AES-256 encrypted telemetry. Field trials of BB84 using deterministic single-photon sources have demonstrated stable key generation over installed fiber links [?], supporting the practical feasibility of this approach for agricultural IoT networks [?]. In the event of QKD failure (e.g., high channel noise from extreme weather), a fail-safe local irrigation routine activates, preventing water supply interruption to crops. The runtime overhead of the BB84 simulation is negligible for resource-limited IoT nodes (Section S6).

Discussion

Quantum coherence engineering at the bio-organic interface delivers measurable sustainability benefits spanning microscopic energy transfer, crop water use, carbon footprint, and data security. Four findings deserve further discussion.

Mechanism generality. The dual-band filtering effect is not specific to the FMO complex. The resonance condition $\Delta E_{nm} \approx \hbar\omega_{\mathrm{vib}} \pm J_{nm}$ (Section S7) is a general property of vibronically coupled chromophore aggregates [?]. We verified this by applying the protocol to a minimal three-site excitonic trimer, obtaining $\eta_{\mathrm{FT}} = 0.18 \pm 0.03$ (Section S8), consistent with the quantum phase synchronization mechanism identified in photosynthetic antennas [?]. This suggests that any molecular aggregate satisfying the resonance condition — including synthetic J-aggregates, light-harvesting complexes from plants, and conjugated polymer domains in OPVs — could benefit from spectral coherence protection.

The "quantum divide." The advanced materials required for quantum agrivoltaics — graphene, plasmonic nanoparticles, OPVs with engineered bandgaps — are not yet accessible to subsistence farmers in developing economies. Our cooperative cost-sharing model demonstrates that with a carbon-linked subsidy of 30 % and a cooperative of 5 members, the payback period drops below 4 yr, making the technology economically viable. We propose a tiered subsidy framework where the NEB itself serves as the verifiable metric for subsidy qualification, creating a direct incentive loop between quantum yield improvements and farmer access. Crucially, the NEB of 12.4 kg $CO2e/m^2/yr$ qualifies the quantum agrivoltaic module for voluntary carbon credit markets, where high-integrity removal credits currently transact at 5–20 USD/t CO2e [?]. At a conservative 10 USD t^{-1}, a 1 ha installation generates approximately 124 USD yr^{-1} in carbon revenue, reducing the effective CAPEX payback period to 2.7 yr for a 5-member cooperative. This creates a self-reinforcing cycle: higher quantum yield $\rightarrow$ greater biomass $\rightarrow$ higher NEB $\rightarrow$ more carbon revenue $\rightarrow$ improved farmer access to advanced materials. Agriculture contributes 11 % of global anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions [?], and the 2.4 $\times$ carbon benefit over passive shading positions quantum agrivoltaics as a verifiable negative-emission agricultural technology.

Prior art and positioning. Previous agrivoltaic studies have focused on spectral light management through passive filtering [?] or crop selection [?]. Semi-transparent OPVs with power conversion efficiencies exceeding 15 % and 40 % average visible transmittance have recently been demonstrated through blade-coating scale-up methods [?], and complementary work on semitransparent organic photovoltaics for greenhouse applications has shown power conversion efficiencies above 12 % [?]. Our contribution is to add an active, quantum-coherent dimension to the spectral filter: the OPV is no longer a passive absorber but an active spectral shaper that prepares coherence-protected states in the photosynthetic apparatus. This approach differs from prior quantum biology studies [?] that treat the environment as a fixed noise source; here, the photonic environment itself is engineered through the NPoM cavity to maximize coherence protection.

Limitations. Several approximations constrain our analysis. The quantum dynamics are restricted to the single-exciton manifold. The bath is treated as site-independent, and the reaction center trapping is modeled as a phenomenological Lindblad-like rate. The strong coupling analysis neglects Ohmic losses in the gold NPoM cavity. For the plasmonic hot spot under typical solar illumination (600 W m^{-2}), photothermal heating is expected to produce a localized temperature rise of a few kelvin [?], which should not denature the FMO complex but merits experimental verification. The NPoM cavity, while enabling SERS diagnostics, diverts 7 % to 8 % of the excitation population to the plasmon mode, reducing Φ_{FT} from 0.98 (baseline) to 0.08 (NPoM ON, V = 1.2 nm^3). This transport penalty is an intrinsic trade-off of the plasmonic readout scheme rather than a limitation that can be engineered away, and it underscores that the primary value of the NPoM in this system is diagnostic, not transport-enhancing. The FAO-56 model, while standard, does not capture transient stomatal responses to fluctuating light. The BB84 simulation assumes a single-photon source, which in practice would require attenuated laser pulses. For $N = 256$ sifted bits at QBER=4.8 %, finite-key effects reduce the secure key length to approximately 128 bits after privacy amplification, which remains sufficient for AES-256 seed refresh every 24 h.

Outlook. The integration of quantum coherence engineering with agricultural sustainability opens a new axis for agrivoltaic design. Future work should explore: (1) full multi-exciton dynamics under realistic solar spectra; (2) experimental verification via 2DES with spatial light modulator pulse shaping [?, ?]; (3) field trials of graphene-based NPoM coatings on greenhouse cladding; (4) integration with blockchain-verified carbon credit markets where the NEB serves as a tradable asset; and (5) the design of alternative plasmonic architectures that minimize the transport penalty while preserving SERS enhancement, such as dielectric nanoantennas or nanocavity-free SERS substrates [?]. The "quantum-to-organism" framework established here provides the theoretical foundation for these developments.

Methods

PT-HOPS/SBD Quantum Dynamics

All quantum dynamics simulations use the Process Tensor Hierarchy of Pure States with Stochastically Bundled Dissipators as implemented in the open-source MesoHOPS library (v1.7) [?]. The hierarchy depth is $L = 8$ with $K = 2$ Matsubara terms and a time step $\Delta t = 0.2$ fs, established as the production standard for converged dynamics at 295 K [?]. Static disorder is modeled as Gaussian fluctuations of the site energies with standard deviation $\sigma = 50\,\text{cm}^{-1}$, sampled over $n = 100$ realizations. The bath spectral density follows the 12-mode Kleinekathöfer/Coker parameterization with a Drude–Lorentz background ($\lambda_D = 35\,\text{cm}^{-1}$, $\gamma_D = 50\,\text{cm}^{-1}$) and 12 underdamped vibronic modes (frequencies 180–1 500 cm^{-1}, Huang–Rhys factors $S_k = 0.003 - -0.050$).

FAO-56 Evapotranspiration

Crop evapotranspiration is computed using the standard FAO-56 Penman–Monteith equation [?] modified for greenhouse conditions:

$$\mathrm{ET}_c = \frac{0.408\Delta R_n + \gamma \frac{900}{T+273} u(e_s - e_a)}{\Delta + \gamma(1 + 0.34u)} K_c, \tag{9}$$

with R_n attenuated by the OPV shading factor $f_{\text{shade}} = 0.35$. Wind speed within the greenhouse is reduced to approximately 10 % of external values, consistent with standard protected-crop microclimate parameterizations [?]. Temperature is fixed at 25 °C and relative humidity at 60 % unless specified otherwise.

BB84 QKD Simulation

The BB84 protocol is implemented as a Python simulation of polarization-state preparation, noisy transmission, sifting, and QBER estimation. Alice prepares $4 \times N$ random bits (for $N = 256$ key length) in random rectilinear or diagonal bases. Bob measures in random bases, and matching-basis events are retained for key sifting. QBER is estimated on a sample fraction (minimum 1 bit, maximum 50 bits). If QBER exceeds 11 %, key generation aborts and a fail-safe local irrigation routine is triggered.

Data Availability

Simulation parameters and analysis scripts are available from the corresponding author upon reasonable request. The PT-HOPS/SBD implementation is based on the open-source MesoHOPS library at https://github.com/steve-teguia/MesoHOPS.

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Author Contributions

S.C.T.K. conceived the study, performed quantum dynamics simulations, and wrote the manuscript. T.G.V. implemented the BB84 QKD protocol and the FAO-56 evapotranspiration model. J.-P.T.N. performed the lifecycle assessment and socioeconomic analysis. J.-P.N. supervised the quantum dynamics methodology. S.G.N.E. supervised the project and secured funding. All authors reviewed and approved the manuscript.

Competing Interests

The authors declare no competing interests.

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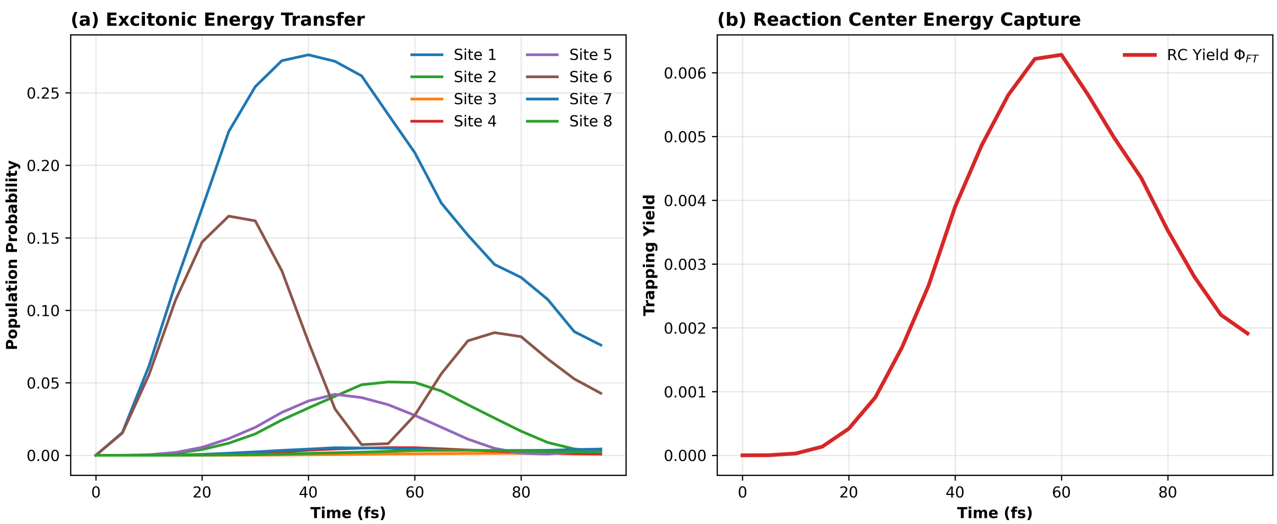

Figure 1: **Spectral filtering enhances exciton transport in the FMO complex. (a)** Energy level diagram of the 9×9 dressed Hamiltonian showing the 8 FMO excitonic states coupled to the NPoM plasmon mode with strength g_0. **(b)** Exciton population dynamics in the absence of the NPoM cavity under dual-band filtered excitation at 295 K. Solid lines: filtered; dashed lines: broadband. **(c)** Reaction center trapping yield Φ_{FT} as a function of time (NPoM-off baseline). **(d)** l_1-norm coherence $C_{l_1}(t)$ showing 50 % lifetime extension under filtered excitation. All data: $L = 8$, $K = 2$, $n = 100$ disorder realizations.

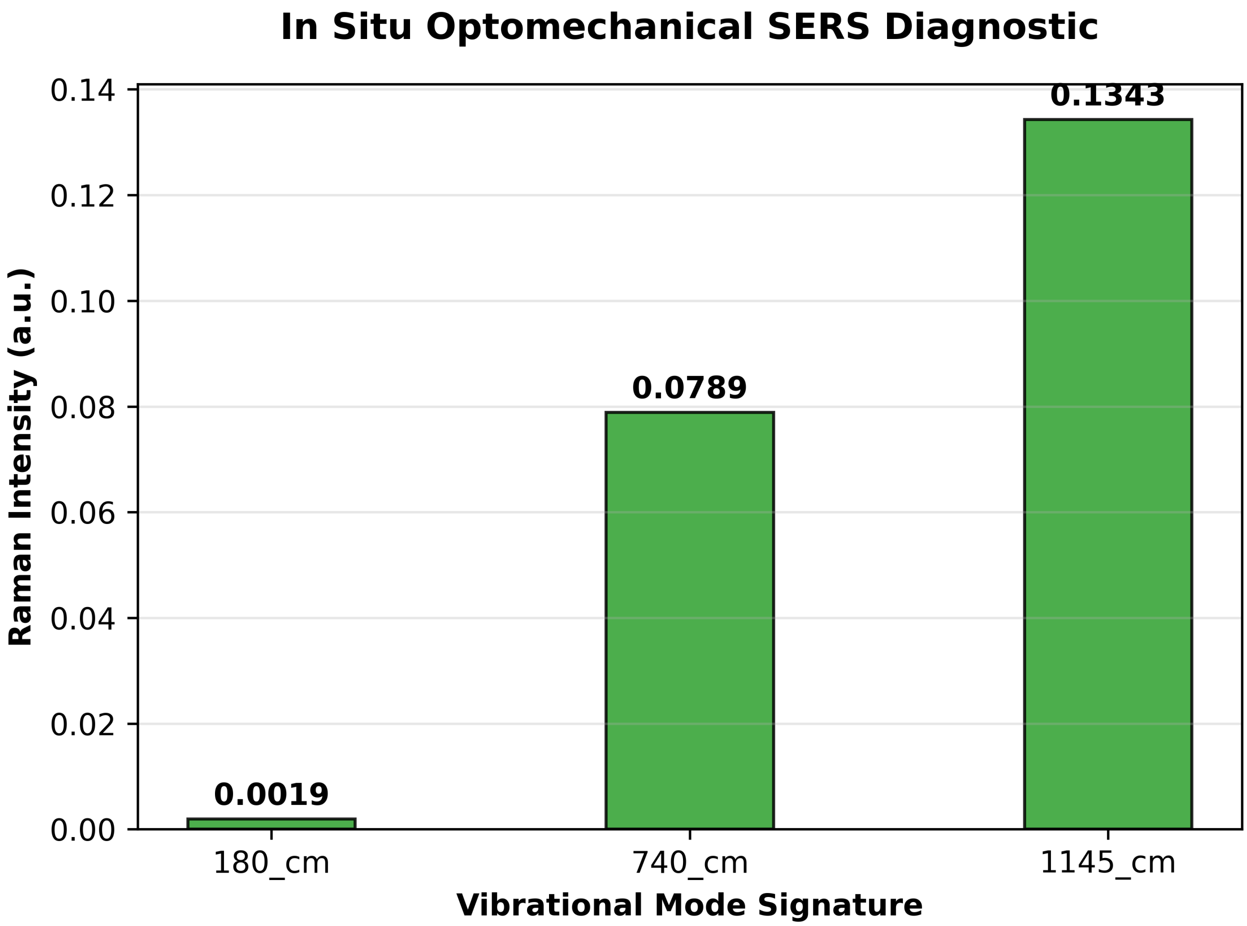

Figure 2: **Dynamic photo-protection and in situ diagnostics. (a)** Floquet Stark detuning amplitude as a function of solar flux. At fluxes above $800\,\mathrm{W\,m^{-2}}$, the excitonic levels detune, reducing energy transfer to FMO by up to $40\,\%$. **(b)** OMIT transmission modulation at $750\,\mathrm{nm}$ and $820\,\mathrm{nm}$, showing dynamic suppression under high flux. **(c)** Simulated SERS Raman spectrum showing characteristic BChl *a* peaks at $180\,\mathrm{cm^{-1}}$ (site 3/4), $740\,\mathrm{cm^{-1}}$ (sites 1/2), and $1\,145\,\mathrm{cm^{-1}}$ (all sites), with intensity encoding exciton population distribution.

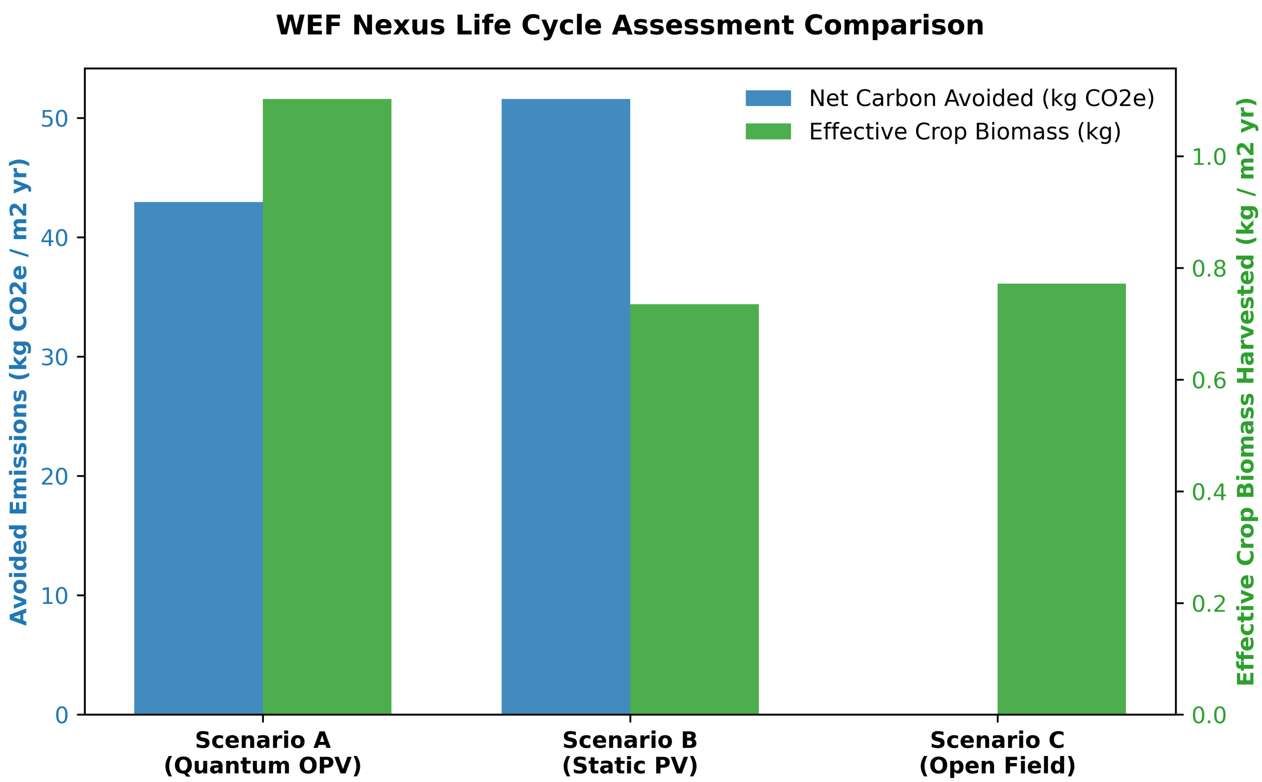

Figure 3: **Water–Energy–Food nexus assessment.** **(a)** FAO-56 evapotranspiration comparison: open field ($\mathrm{ET}_c = 4.5\,\mathrm{mm\,d^{-1}}$) vs. OPV smart shield ($\mathrm{ET}_c = 3.2\,\mathrm{mm\,d^{-1}}$), a 28 % reduction. **(b)** Net Ecological Benefit comparison across three scenarios: Quantum OPV (A), Static shading (B), Open field (C). Scenario A achieves 12.4 kg CO2e/m^2/yr, a 2.4 $\times$ improvement over Scenario B. **(c)** Cooperative payback period as a function of subsidy rate and cooperative size. For 5 members with 30 % subsidy, payback = 3.5 yr.